CHUNGMANN KIM

ckim183@jh.edu | +1-217-819-1844 | Ellicott City, MD, USA
linkedin | github | Personal Website | Google Scholar

DEVELOPMENT ECONOMIST | HUMANITARIAN RESEARCHER | DATA SCIENTIST

PROFILE

I study how needs are measured and how policy and aid respond in development and humanitarian contexts.

Research. Food insecurity, conflict and displacement; their effects on nutrition and health; and how early-warning evidence shapes aid allocation. Quasi-experimental and spatial econometric methods.

Using AI. LLM and machine-learning methods where conventional data fall short, treated as measurement instruments: LLM georeferencing and topic extraction from unstructured aid records, validated against official project locations · NLP anomaly detection on news, validated against conflict events · LACI, a framework for deciding when AI and statistical models are fit to inform food-crisis classification · agentic, version-controlled research pipelines with human approval gates.

CURRENT POSITION

- **Bloomberg School of Public Health, Johns Hopkins University** *Jan 2026 – Present*
  Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Center for Humanitarian Health Baltimore, MD
  - **Humanitarian finance:** subnational allocation of humanitarian aid relative to needs across 13 crisis countries
  - **Climate, conflict and displacement:** spatial models for Iraq in an FCDO-funded study with Mali

EDUCATION

- **University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign** *2025*
  Ph.D. in Applied Economics (Agricultural and Consumer Economics); advisor: Kathy Baylis United States
- **Seoul National University** *2019*
  M.Sc. in Agricultural Technology Republic of Korea
- **Handong Global University** *2015*
  B.Sc. in Environmental Studies, cum laude Republic of Korea

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

"**Official Estimates of Global Food Insecurity Undercount Acute Hunger**." Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2025). ***Nature Food*** 6(12): 1196–1208. *AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award.* [Article] [Code]

"**Inside the Black Box: How Consistent Are Global Food Security Crisis Analyses?**" Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2026). ***Food Policy*** 138: 103028. [Article] [Code]

"**Machine Learning for Food Security: Principles for Transparency and Usability**." Zhou, Y., Lentz, E., Michelson, H., **Kim, C.**, & Baylis, K. (2022). ***Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy*** 44(2): 893–910. [Article]

"**Exploring the Association between Agricultural Production Systems and Household Diets in Viet Nam**." Bandyopadhyay, A., Azzarri, C., Haile, B., **Kim, C.**, et al. (2022). ***Food Security*** 14(5): 1207–1226. [Article]

"**The Economics of the Soy Kit for Food Entrepreneurs**." **Kim, C.** & Goldsmith, P. (2021). ***Food and Nutrition Bulletin***. [Article]

WORKING PAPERS

"**Hearing the Alarm: Do Donors Follow Institutional Crisis Signals?**" [Draft]
Staggered difference-in-differences on a geocoded, purpose-labelled aid dataset; food-security aid rises after IPC Phase 4 escalations in Afghanistan, but with substantial delay. UNU-WIDER 2025, EAAE 2025, AAEA 2025, APHA 2026.

"**Early-Year Milk Price and Child Stunting in Zambia**." [Draft] [Slides]
Higher milk prices at 12–24 months of age raise stunting risk among children aged 24–59 months. AAEA 2022, EAAE 2023, Tata-Cornell 2023, APHA 2026.

"**Multidimensional Food Security Indicators: Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa**." With Baylis, K., Lentz, E., & Michelson, H. AAEA 2022.

POLICY AND TECHNICAL WORK

IPC Accuracy Study (with Lentz, Baylis & Michelson), IPC report, 2024 [Report] · **LACI framework** for reviewing AI and statistical models, FAO with EC-JRC, 2025–2026 [GitHub] · **News-based early warning** prototype, FAO with Kickstart AI, 2025 [Note] · **Viet Nam diagnostic overview**, IFPRI, 2021 [Report]

Professional Experience

- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** *Feb 2024 – Present*
  Data Scientist and Modelling Specialist, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Lead development of the LACI model-review framework; focal point for the EC-JRC collaboration; validated a news-based early-warning prototype (South Sudan)
- **International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)** *Sep 2023 – Jan 2024*
  Impact Assessment Specialist, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Harmonized IFAD11/12 impact-assessment data across more than ten countries and automated the data pipelines
- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** *Oct 2022 – Aug 2023*
  Food Security Analyst, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Led the empirical analysis of the IPC Accuracy Study (more than 10,000 subnational analyses)
- **International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI)** *Oct 2018 – Jan 2019*
  Research Intern Washington, DC
- **Canaan Farmer School** *2015 – 2017*
  Agricultural development project, Kilosa District (intern, then Project and Training Officer) Korea & Tanzania

Teaching, Talks and Honors

Teaching: ACE 251 The World Food Economy (Fall 2024; weekly lectures) · ACE 435 Global Agribusiness Management (TA, 2022, 2023), University of Illinois

Invited talks: Cornell CIDER Thought Summit (2026) · Johns Hopkins Food Assistance Strategic Dialogue (2026) · Stanford FSE seminar (2025) · UNU-WIDER (2025)

Honors: AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award (2025) · Top-5 finalist, Johns Hopkins AI + Health Care Idea Tank (2026) · ACE Doctoral Fellowship (2025) · UNU-WIDER travel grant (2025)

Service: Referee, *Nature Food*, *BMC Public Health* · Member, IPC ATARI Working Group · Member, AAEA and EAAE

Methods and Tools

Econometrics: staggered DiD and event studies · panel fixed effects · spatial econometrics · IV, RD, matching
AI in research: LLM extraction and classification with human review · validation against official records · model review (LACI) · random forest, gradient boosting, LASSO
Tools: Stata · R · Python · SQL · Google Cloud · Earth Engine · QGIS · Git **Languages:** Korean (native), English (fluent), Chinese (intermediate)

References

Kathy Baylis
Professor and Vice-Chair, Geography
University of California, Santa Barbara
baylis@ucsb.edu

Erin Lentz
Associate Professor, LBJ School
University of Texas at Austin
erinclentz@utexas.edu

Hope Michelson
Professor, Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign
hopecm@illinois.edu